

University Centre Abdelhafid Boussouf E-learning Centre



English – Level2

– Lesson 04 – Sentence Structure

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Science and Technology	• Mathematics and Computer Science • Technical Science	Licentiate 2	-MI -ST
Economic Science	• Economic Science • Commercial Science • Management Science	Licentiate 2	All specialties

Objectives of the Lesson:

- To be aware of the different structures of sentences.
- To be capable of generating sentences belonging to the various classes.
- To be able to distinguish between a sentence, a phrase and a clause.

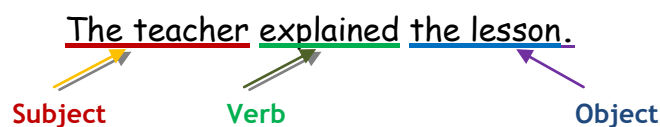
1. WHAT IS A SENTENCE?

A **sentence** is a grammatical unit; it is a group of words that convey a complete meaning. A **sentence** must have one independent central idea that can stand alone. Every sentence must contain a **subject** and a **verb**. A **sentence** can be a single clause. A **sentence** must end with a period/full stop (.), a question mark (?), or an exclamation mark (!).

The **subject** describes the person or thing doing the action. The **subject** can be a **single word**, as well as a **noun phrase**, a **noun clause**, a **pronoun**, an **infinitive phrase** (As in: **To sing** takes practice).

The **verb** makes a statement about the subject and expresses activity; it shows an action, or a state of being.

Example:



1. SENTENCE STRUCTURE

There are **four types** of sentence structure: **simple**, **compound**, **complex**, and **compound-complex**.

The elements of sentences are: **subject**, **verb**, **object**, **complement** and **adverbial**. *(Of course, not all these elements should be present for a sentence to retain its identity).

1. SIMPLE SENTENCE

A **simple sentence** is a group of words that contains one subject and one verb. A simple sentence consists of one independent clause. The basic pattern of a simple sentence is: • **Subject** + **verb**.

The following are other possible patterns in a simple sentence:

- **Subject** + **verb** + **object**
- **Subject** + **verb** + **object** + **object**
- **Subject** + **verb** + **complement**
- **Subject** + **verb** + **object** + **complement**
- **Subject** + **verb** + **adverbial**
- **Subject** + **verb** + **object** + **adverbial**

Examples:

The woman left.

Subject Verb

Your costume is very nice.

Subject Verb Complement

I love coffee.

Subject Verb object

The exam is today.

Subject Verb Adverbial

2. COMPONED SENTENCE

A **compound sentence** is a sentence made up of two simple sentences. In other words, a compound sentence contains two independent clauses joined by a conjunction (Such as: **and**, **or**, **for**, **yet**, **but** or **so**), and usually separated by a comma (,). When **the subject** is the same in all parts of the sentence, there is no need to repeat it (See example 02 below). Like a simple sentence, a **compound sentence** has different patterns as well. The basic word order of a compound sentence is:

- **Subject** + **verb** + **conjunction** + **subject** + **verb**

Examples:

Janna called and I answered. (*No comma before and)

Sentence (Clause) 1 Conjunction Sentence (Clause) 2

Sam is excellent at physics, but not very good at math.

Sentence (Clause) 1 Conjunction Sentence (Clause) 2

3. COMPLEX SENTENCE

A **complex sentence** is made up of **one independent (main) clause** and at least **one dependent (subordinate) clause**, often joined with a **subordinating conjunction** (Such as: **although, until, because, in order to, when...**). Usually, when the dependent clause precedes the independent clause in a sentence, a **comma (,)** is used to separate the two clauses.

Examples:

When I began my healthy diet, I became vegan.

Dependent Clause Independent Clause

The suspect said that he was innocent.

Dependent Clause Subordinating conjunction Independent Clause

4. COMPOUND-COMPLEX SENTENCE

A **compound-complex** sentence includes elements of both **compound** and **complex** sentences. A compound-complex sentence is comprised of at least **two independent clauses** and at least **one dependent clause** joined with a **coordinating conjunction** and/or a **subordinating conjunction**. The **comma** is placed before **the coordinating conjunction (both, neither, whether...)** and after the dependent clause when it occurs at the beginning of the sentence.

Examples:

After I wake up in the morning, I go for a walk, and I buy my favorite coffee.

Dependent Clause Independent Clause 1 Independent Clause 2

Joe does not like tea because it is tasteless, so he does not drink it.

Independent Clause 1 Dependent Clause Independent Clause

Let's Practice!

Are the following sentences simple, compound, complex, or compound-complex?

1. The theater was very dark.
2. The student studied hard so that he might succeed
3. That was my neighbor who lives next door.
4. I cracked the egg and then scrambled it.
5. Whenever I go out I visit the library because I love books.
6. My computer was made in the United States.

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